

## The Gurus@OSI

- Abhijit Das, Konsulte
- Akarsh Sinha, engineering student, IIT Madras
- Amit Shah, Red Hat
- Anil Warrier, Microsoft
- Arun Bhardwaj, Dell
- Ashish Mathur, IBM
- B.C. Sekar, HCL
- Benard Sitangang, Centre for Empowerment of OSS—ITB, Indonesia
- Boudhayan Gupta, FOSS enthusiast & hacker
- Bhuvaneshwar A, CollabNet
- C.N. Krishnan, AU-KBC & NRCFOSS
- C.R. Muthukrishnan, IIT Madras
- D. Janakiram, IIT Madras
- D. Seetharam, IBM
- Dhiraj Sinha, Perot Systems
- Dibya Prakash, Azri Inc.
- Farida Umrani-Khan, IIT Bombay
- Gautam Sinha, CTO, Times Business Solutions
- H.R. Mohan, IEEE Computer Society
- J.A. Bhavsar, ITM, Kharghar
- John Smedley, Ingres Corporation
- Krich Nasingkun, National Electronics and Computer Technology, Thailand
- Krish Ashok, TCS
- Lim Kin Chew, SIM University, Singapore
- M. Sasikumar, C-DAC
- Martyn YAP, SIM University, Singapore
- Muthu Ramadoss, Android Rocks
- N.S. Gowri Ganesh, C-DAC
- Narendra Bhandari, Intel
- Naval Khosla, IBM
- P. Balasubramanian, NIC
- P.K. Mishra, Novell
- Rajesh Iyer, Essentia
- Rakshit Hooja, IDA Systems
- Redhuan D. Oon, leader, ADempire Project
- S. Ramakrishnan, C-DAC
- S. Srinivasan, NRCFOSS AU-KBC Research Centre
- Sambath Na Parthasarathy, Senior Data Centre Consultant, IBM
- Satyaakam Goswami, consultant
- Shishir Jain, CEO, Netelligence Technologies
- Shuveb Hussain, K7 Computing
- Sonali Minocha, CTO, OSSCube
- Sridhar Iyer, IIT Bombay
- Srivaths N.S., Dell
- Steve Lau, Hong Kong OSS Centre
- Subramaniam Bharati & Chennai LUG Team
- Sumeet Arora, Evon Technologies
- Supreet Sethi, consultant
- T. Shrinivasan, Cloudvaristy
- Thilak Kumar, Wind River
- Tim Cloonan, JasperSoft
- Varad Gupta, head, Kean & Able
- Venkat Mangudi, Venkat Mangudi Consulting
- Venkatesh Kumaravel, IBM
- Vikash Jha, HSBC Investsmart
- Vineet Agrawal, co-founder, OSSCube
- Vivek Bhatnagar, Ingres Corporation

We hope we have been able to include all our speakers in this list. If we have missed someone please be assured that it's certainly not our intention.

## We can't 'Thank You' enough!

The organisers would like to take this opportunity to thank all those who played a significant role in shaping OSI:

- Dr S Ramakrishnan, director general, CDAC, for a highly motivating inaugural speech and for encouraging us despite some initial hiccups at the inauguration.
- Dr Rajagopalan, executive director, CDAC, for suggesting Chennai as the venue for OSI and supporting us throughout the planning and execution phases.
- Dr Sasikumar, principal research scientist, CDAC, for helping us shape the agenda for FOSS-enabled education workshop and for giving us guidance from time-to-time on how to improve the activities.
- The entire CDAC Chennai team for not only sponsoring the show, but also assisting us in executing the same. Special thanks to Mr Nagesh Ramarao for supporting us in various aspects of execution.
- The entire IBM team for supporting OSI as Gold Sponsors—an initiative that was spearheaded by Ms Reetika Sagar, marketing manager, Linux and Mr Sunil Wangnoo, marketing manager, software group of IBM.
- Dr S Srinivasan, project scientist, AU-KBC, for connecting us with many key people who ended up supporting OSI.
- The entire Chennai LUG for supporting OSI wholeheartedly.
- Mr Ranjit Sengupta, CEO, Advantage Pro, who worked overtime to help us connect with engineering colleges and to ensure that the next generation of engineers were exposed to merits of Open Source
- Our exhibitors—Lynux Academy, Advantage Pro, Learning Linux Centre, Chennai LUG, IIT Mumbai and Open Street Map.
- Last but not the least, all our speakers, who came from all parts of India to share their knowledge, and all of you who took out time to attend OSI.

asked about the connection of FOSS with cloud computing, whereas others raised questions about the security of the data. Cost was another factor that was discussed. However, there seems to be some misunderstanding about the 'free as in freedom' aspect. Some folks from a leading India ISP reported about a perception that where things are 'free', there's automatically a lot of concern about security. While the panel covered all worries about security, they stayed away from going into the actual implications of what 'free' meant in FOSS. There is obviously still a lot of confusion about this magic word even among open source users.

Talking about the importance of staying safe, one panelist's memorable quote was: "It's good to be passionate about something, but it's even better to be bullet-proof." Implying that no matter what technology you use, security is something you should keep as top priority.

The third session of the day discussed the various FOSS virtualisation technologies in use. The panelists included Amit Shah, KVM developer at Red Hat, Shuveb Hussain, entrepreneur and free software developer, P.K. Mishra and Venkat Mangudi. The discussion was moderated by Gautam Sinha, CTO, Times Business Solutions.

When a member of the audience raised the important request for help in choosing one from among the various

technologies, Shah covered all bases. He said that it was most important to always ask for a trial, to test two or three technologies, and see which one meets your needs the best. He warned against blindly going after only one solution without testing others.

This session was apparently 'hijacked' by Novell's P.K. Mishra, making it one of the most entertaining at the event. Given that the audience was shooting off question after question, Sinha had to extend the session well beyond its time limit.

## Dedicated to education

Targeted at the academia, 'FOSS-enabled Education' was the third parallel track of the day. Discussions were held on topics like 'A FOSS-powered IT set up', 'FOSS and education', 'Teaching FOSS', 'Open source in higher education' and so on. Prof. Bhavsar, Group Head (IT), Institute of Technology and Management, Kharghar (a place in the suburbs of Mumbai), said that while paid software has its own advantages, very few educational institutions can afford to buy and use paid software to meet all their needs. This is best met by open source software, which has its own merits. Being free is not its only attraction—also inherent in the open source philosophy is the freedom of a distributed community of programmers to modify and improve the code. This model exemplifies the best of humanitarian efforts for a social cause.